

LocalCaption — Interview Mode Guide

Oct 2, 2026 · @pole

Overview

Interview mode captions the interviewer's audio on your Mac and sends their questions to an AI coach (ChatGPT, through the Codex app) that drafts an answer you can say out loud. Everything — captions, questions, answers, screenshots — is saved in LocalCaption's local database.

An interview runs in five steps:

1. **Choose Interview** on the first screen.
2. **Prepare** — who, where, your CV, the job description and the answering mode.
3. **Interview** — record, and press the Ask hotkey after each question.
4. **End** — summarize, or send follow-up prompts.
5. **Review** — past interviews in the Sessions window.

Before you start

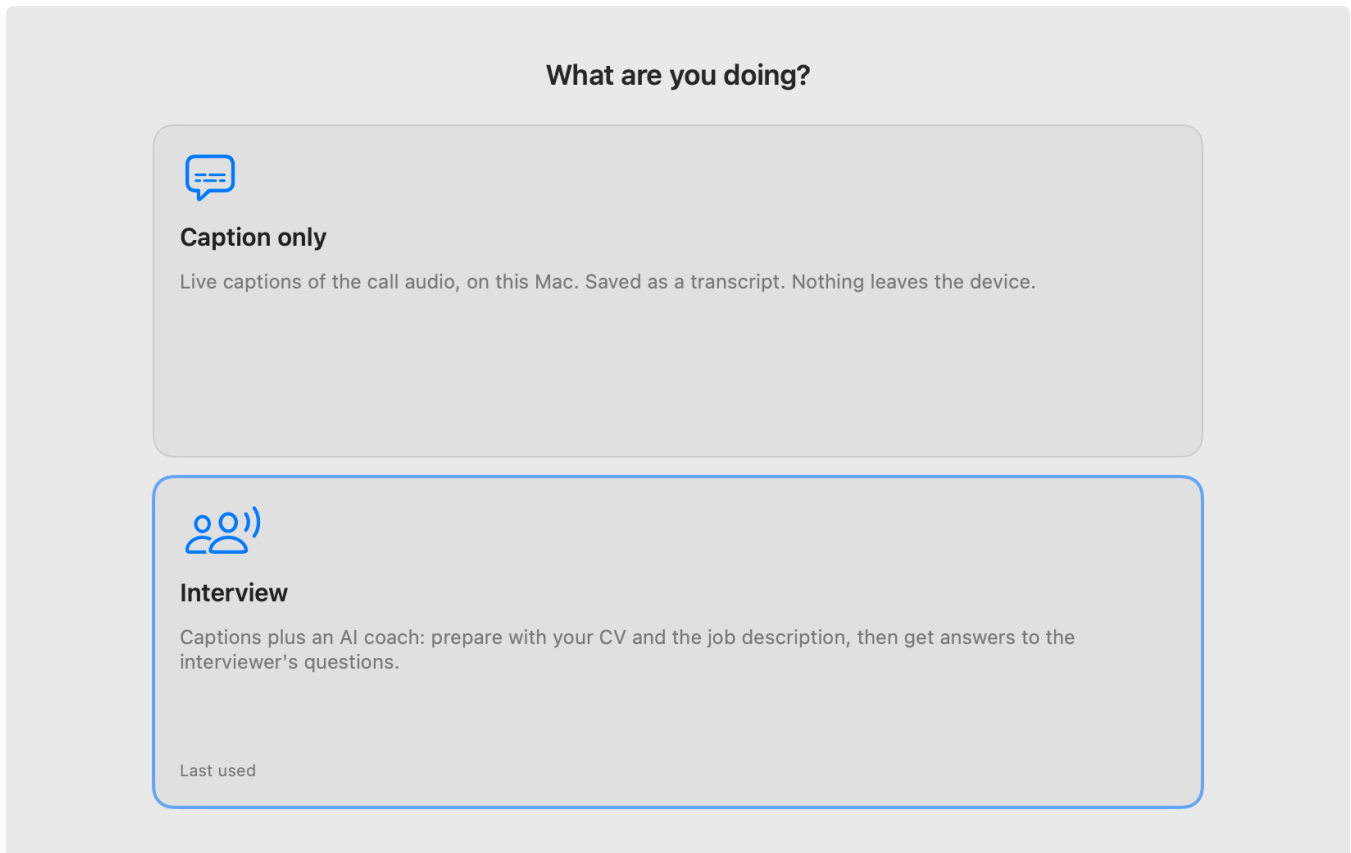
Set these up once. The preparation screen tells you if any is missing.

What	Where	Why
Codex installed	Terminal: <code>brew install codex</code>	The coach runs through the Codex app
Signed in to ChatGPT	Settings → Codex, or Sign in... on the preparation screen	Answers use your ChatGPT plan
The 4 skills loaded	Settings → Interview → Skills: <code>discovery-cv</code> , <code>discovery-jd</code> , <code>apply-instruction</code> , <code>live-coding-design</code>	Start preparation runs them; Start is disabled until all 4 are loaded
Screen Recording permission	macOS asks on first Start	Captures the call's audio, and screenshots

The first time you choose Interview, a privacy notice explains what is sent to OpenAI: your CV, the job description and skills when you prepare, the interviewer's recent words on each Ask, and screenshots you add. Caption only sends nothing.

Step 1 — Choose Interview mode

LocalCaption opens on a mode choice. Click **Interview** (or press Return when it is marked *Last used*).



To switch later, click the mode button at the left of the top bar (for example **Interview**). It shows only while nothing is recording or unsaved.

Step 2 — Prepare

The preparation fills the window on its own. When every step finishes, LocalCaption switches to the captions and answers.

Interview
Ready
Coach not started
A 14 A

Interview

Interviewee
Company
Step 2 ⬆️⬆️

Session name: Alex-Northwind-2-2026-10-02

1 Discovery CV

⬆️⬆️
Upload CV...

2 Discovery JD

Senior iOS Engineer — Northwind Health Remote (EU). Swift, SwiftUI, offline-first sync, accessibility. You will lead the patient app's new appointment flow.

3 Apply instruction

Intro

Tech

Behavioral

Applied by Start preparation. During the interview you can switch modes from the header.

4 Live coding & design (optional)

☐ Use live coding & system design answers (needs the Tech mode)

Model

Preparation effort
Answer effort

Low answer effort answers fastest. These are the same settings as Settings → Interview.

⚡ Start preparation

[Skip preparation](#)

- 1. Interview** — enter the **Interviewee** and **Company** (both required) and the **Step** (1 for the first round, 2 for the second...). The session is named from them, for example `Alex-Northwind-2-2026-10-02`. The interviewee is prefilled from your last interview.
- 2. ① Discovery CV** — pick a CV, or **Upload CV...** (PDF, Markdown or text).
- 3. ② Discovery JD** — paste the job description.
- 4. ③ Apply instruction** — choose how answers are shaped: **Intro**, **Tech** or **Behavioral**.

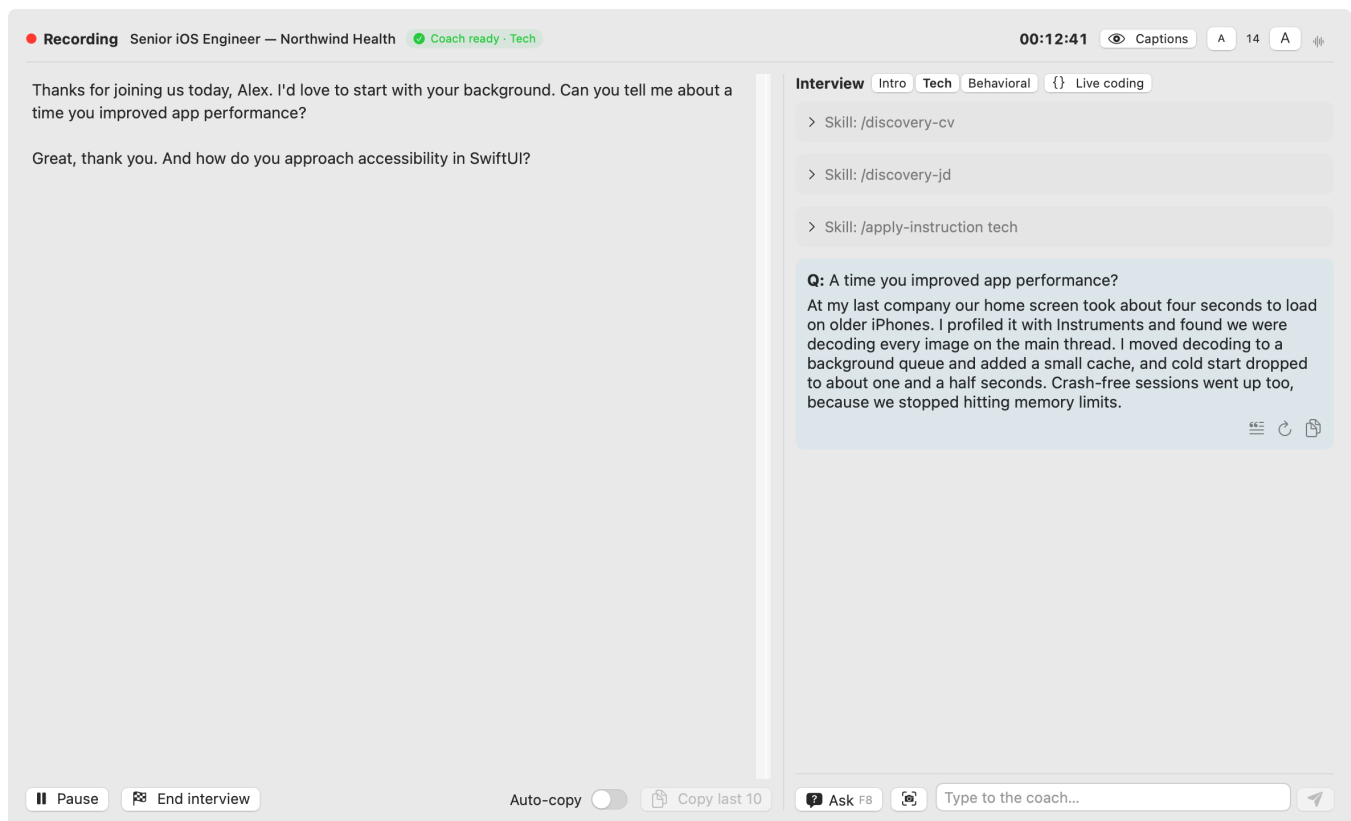
5. ④ **Live coding & design** (optional) — tick it for coding and system-design rounds. It needs Tech.
6. **Model and effort** — the recommended model is fine. **Answer effort Low** answers fastest; **Preparation effort** only affects these steps.
7. Click **Start preparation**. Each part shows a spinner, then a ✓.

If the button is disabled, the reason is shown under it. If a step fails, the screen says where it stopped: **Continue** picks up from that step, **Start over** reruns everything.

- **Skip preparation** (bottom right) goes straight to the interview unprepared; the coach still answers.
- **Preparation** in the top bar brings this screen back before you press Start. If you are already prepared, the link reads **Back to the interview**.

Step 3 — During the interview

Press **Start** under the captions when the call begins. After each question, press **F8** (the Ask hotkey) and read the answer on the right.



Asking

- Press the **Ask hotkey** (F8 by default) or the **Ask** button. The hotkey works while Zoom, Meet or Teams has focus.
- By default it sends everything the interviewer said since your last Ask, including the line still being captioned, up to 400 words. Settings can send the latest N sentences instead.
- Ask while an answer is still coming and the new question replaces it (or waits, if you choose Queue in Settings).

Reading the answer card

- **Q:** is the coach's short reading of the question — a quick check that it understood. Below it is the answer, written to be said out loud.
- The three icons under an answer: what was sent, another answer, copy.
- Earlier cards fold up; the newest stays open.

More ways to talk to the coach

- **Type to the coach...** — the box starts as one line and grows as you type. Return sends.
- **Screenshots** — press **F9** or the camera button, then drag over the area to capture (Esc cancels, Space picks a window). LocalCaption hides while you select. The image waits in the prompt, and the next Ask or Send takes it (up to 10).
- **Answer mode mid-interview** — click **Intro**, **Tech** or **Behavioral** in the panel header, or **Live coding** once Tech is active.

Under the captions: **Pause / Resume**, **Auto-copy** (copies recent captions as they finalize) and **Copy last 10**.

Arranging the window

The window often sits in a narrow strip beside the call, so the panels adapt. Your choices are remembered.

To	Do this
Give one panel more room	Drag the border between captions and answers. Double-click it to reset.
See only the answers	Click Captions in the top bar. Start / Pause / Stop move to the top bar as icons.

To	Do this
Fix the arrangement	Settings → Interview → Layout: Automatic (side by side from 820 pt wide, stacked below), Side by side , or Stacked (answers on top).
Change the text size	The A / A buttons in the top bar.

Step 4 — End the interview

Press **End interview** (⌘.) under the captions. The session is saved at once, then LocalCaption asks what the coach should do:

- **Summarize the interview** — an overview, every question asked with the strongest answer angle, follow-ups you promised, what to prepare next time, and a thank-you email draft.
- **Or send a follow-up prompt** — for example, *Draft a thank-you email to the interviewer.*
- **Not now** — do either later.

The window then shows the finished interview: the summary on top, the transcript, CV and JD beside the conversation, and a box for more follow-up prompts. Press **Start** to begin a new interview; it opens on the preparation again.

Step 5 — Review past interviews

Open the **Sessions** window with ⌘L or the list button at the top right of the main window. Select a session to see everything about it.

The screenshot displays the LocalCaption Interview Mode interface. On the left, a sidebar shows a search bar and a list of sessions. The main panel shows details for a session titled 'Alex-Northwind-2-2026-10-02'. Below the title, there's a table with session metadata: Interviewee (Alex), Step (2), Mode (Tech), Model (gpt-6-luna · low), Company (Northwind), Role (Senior iOS Engineer — Northwind Health), CV (Alex Morgan CV), and Questions (1). A 'Delete...' button is in the top right. Below the metadata, there's a 'Read-only' status and a 'Profile: Tech' label. A 'Summary' section follows, containing an 'Overview' (technical round on performance and accessibility), 'Questions asked' (two questions about app performance and SwiftUI), 'Follow-ups' (send case study), 'Prepare next time' (system-design story), and a 'Thank-you note' (Hi Sam, thanks for today's conversation...). At the bottom, there's a transcript viewer with tabs for 'Transcript', 'CV', and 'JD'. The 'Transcript' tab is active, showing a conversation snippet. To the right of the transcript, there's a list of skills discovered: '/discovery-cv', '/discovery-jd', and '/apply-instruction tech'. A 'Copy Q&A' button is in the top right of the transcript area.

- **The list** — search by name, interviewee, company, role, CV or job description. The sort menu filters to Interviews or Captions and sorts by date, name or length.
- **The details** — interviewee, company, step, role, mode, CV, model and number of questions, then the summary, the conversation and the transcript / CV / JD.
- **Open in Interview Panel** — loads the interview into the main window, where you can summarize it or send follow-up prompts on the same conversation. It waits while a session is recording or unsaved, and asks before discarding a preparation you haven't started.
- **Right-click a session** — Rename..., Reveal in Finder, Delete.... Deleting asks whether to remove the interview data and the exported transcript file too.

Everything — captions, questions, answers, screenshots, summaries — is stored in LocalCaption's local database. A `.txt` and `.json` copy of each transcript is also written to the transcript folder.

Settings reference

Open Settings with `⌘,` or the gear at the top right. Interview mode uses four tabs.

Hotkeys

Ask hotkey

F8

Record...

Reset to F8

On Apple keyboards hold fn with the F-key, or turn on System Settings → Keyboard → “Use F1, F2, etc. keys as standard function keys”. Otherwise it's a media key.

Screenshot hotkey

F9

Record...

Reset to F9

On Apple keyboards hold fn with the F-key, or turn on System Settings → Keyboard → “Use F1, F2, etc. keys as standard function keys”. Otherwise it's a media key.

Screenshot: drag to select an area of the screen; it's added to the current prompt and the next Ask or Send takes it. Esc cancels; Space switches to picking a window. LocalCaption hides while you select. Both hotkeys work in Interview mode, even while the call app has focus.

What to send

Send

Everything since my last ask ↕

At most 400 words



While an answer is still coming

Interrupt it and answer the new question ↕

The live, not-yet-final caption line is always included, so you can press right as the interviewer stops.

Screenshots

Add screenshots to the current prompt automatically



Clear the screenshot from the clipboard after sending



When on, every screenshot you copy during an interview (⌘^⌘4) is added to the current prompt — up to 10. The next Ask or Send takes them all to OpenAI. Images already on the clipboard when the interview opens are ignored; only images are read, never text.

Tab	Section	What it sets
Interview	Skills	Load, replace or remove the 4 skill files
Interview	Model & answers	Model, Answer effort, Skill steps & summary effort, Answer length
Interview	Layout	Captions and answers: Automatic, Side by side, Stacked
Interview	Privacy	Show the privacy notice again
Asking	Hotkeys	Ask hotkey (default F8) and Screenshot hotkey (default F9): Record... a new one, or reset
Asking	What to send	Everything since my last ask, or the latest N sentences; at most N words; interrupt or queue while an answer is coming
Asking	Screenshots	Add screenshots you copy (⌘ ^ ↑ 4) automatically; clear them from the clipboard after sending
Prompts	Prompts	Custom instructions added to every interview
Codex	Codex, Plus usage	Sign-in status, Codex path, and how much of your plan is left

Tips and troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
F8 or F9 does nothing	On Apple keyboards hold fn with the key, or turn on System Settings → Keyboard → “Use F1, F2, etc. keys as standard function keys”. Or record a combination such as Ctrl+Alt+A.
An orange “F8 unavailable” chip in the top bar	Another app owns that key. Pick a different one in Settings → Asking. The Ask and camera buttons still work.
An orange usage chip, for example “5-hour: 12% left”	Your ChatGPT plan is running low; answers stop at 0%. Settings → Codex shows when it resets.

Problem	Fix
The Q: line misreads the question	Speech recognition misheard. Type the question to the coach, or press Ask again once more has been said.
Screenshots show only the desktop	Allow LocalCaption in System Settings → Privacy & Security → Screen Recording.
Start is disabled	Load the 4 skills in Settings → Interview → Skills, and wait for the speech model to finish loading.
The app quit during an interview	On the next launch, Recover unsaved sessions offers the captions saved so far. Click Recover & Save ; the interview is linked to it.

Privacy. Captioning runs entirely on your Mac. Interview mode sends OpenAI, through Codex, only what is listed in *Before you start*. The coach cannot read files or run commands, and searches the web only when a skill or you ask for research — never while answering the interviewer.